carry back the venous blood from the heart and throat are called the jugular veins, and the branches which return the blood from the trunk and extremities are termed venæ cavæ. Through these the blood is emptied into the right auricle, and from thence through the tricuspid valve into the right ventricle. Here what is called the great systemic circulation ends, and here the pulmonary or lesser circulation commences. It must be remembered that we started on our analysis by tracing the blood from the left ventricle, but before it can reach this point there must intervene that complete pulmonary circuit through the lungs to which we have previously called attention. The object of this lesser system of circulation is, as before stated, to expose the blood to the oxygen inhaled by the act of respiration, and thus to effect that radical change which converts the dark venous flow into the healthful and vitalizing condition of arterial blood.

The wonders of the circulatory system, and the effects of health or disease which result from a thorough understanding of its influence, cannot of course be fully appreciated from the condensed description which is herewith presented. It is enough to say, however, that if, as the best informed physiologists allow, a single grain of poison infused into any given portion of the organism will traverse the whole circulatory extent of tubing in something less than three minutes of time, what an array of poisonous elements are we not perpetually introducing into our systems, in the shape of vitiated airs, fermented liquors, and injurious articles of food, by